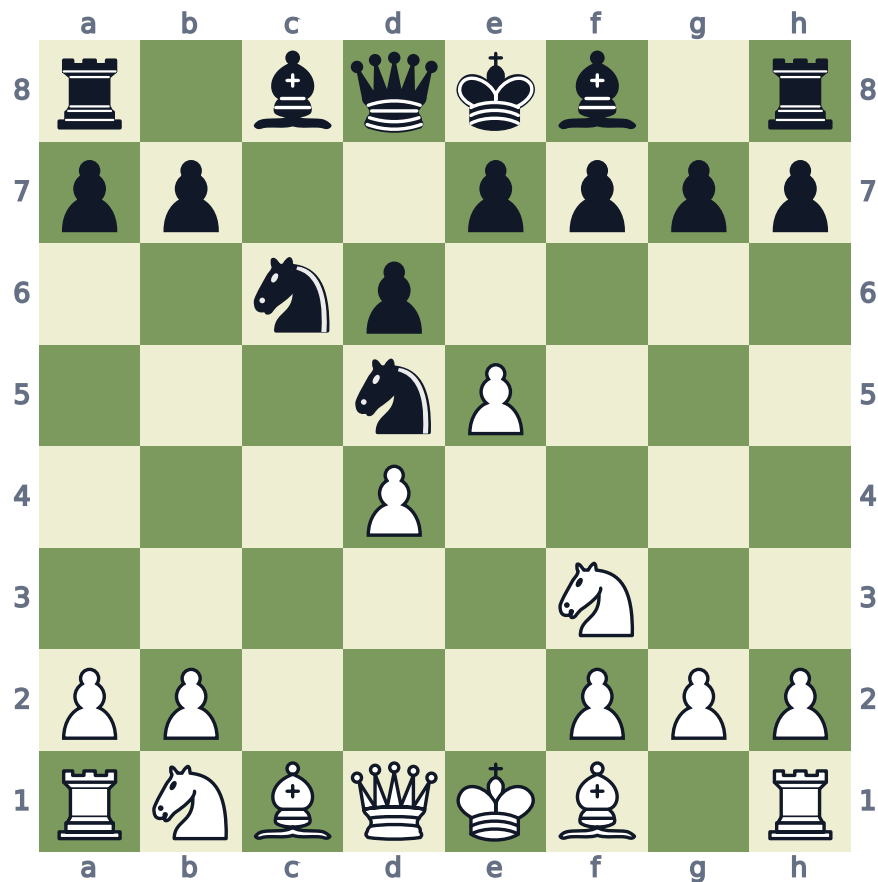


Alapin Sicilian Repertoire

A practical 2.c3 system against 1...c5 with central control and reduced move-order burden



Use 2.c3 to prepare d4, understand Black's immediate counterstrikes, and reach playable centers against every major reply.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Use 2.c3 to prepare d4, understand Black's immediate counterstrikes, and reach playable centers against every major reply.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

c3 prepares d4 but temporarily occupies the knight's natural square.

PRINCIPLE 2

Black should attack the center with ...d5 or ...Nf6.

PRINCIPLE 3

After e5, White gains space but must defend the pawn chain.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

After exd5, development matters more than keeping queens on the board.

PRINCIPLE 5

A delayed Alapin can transpose after Nf3 and ...e6.

PRINCIPLE 6

The system is practical because structures repeat across move orders.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

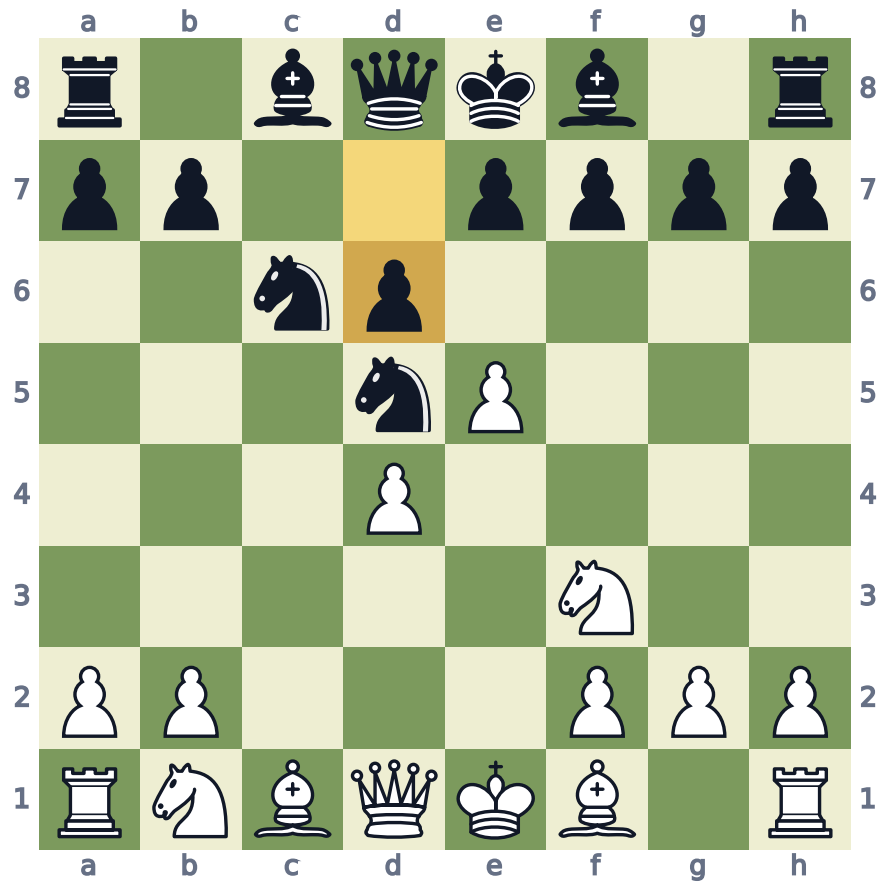
- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------------|--|
| 01 | Alapin ...Nf6 | ...Nf6 provokes e5; support the chain rather than overextend it. |
| 02 | Alapin ...d5 | When Black achieves ...d5, develop with tempo and keep a healthy center. |
| 03 | Alapin ...e6 | ...e6 and ...d5 transpose to a favorable familiar pawn chain. |
| 04 | Alapin ...d6 | If Black delays ...d5, occupy d4 and complete development. |
| 05 | Alapin ...g6 | Against a fianchetto, defend the center with pieces before expanding. |
| 06 | Alapin ...Nc6 | ...Nc6 adds pressure to d4; clarify the center on favorable terms. |
| 07 | Alapin ...b6 | When ...Bb7 targets e4, add a defender before routine castling. |
| 08 | Delayed Alapin | Recognize the structure even when Nf3 precedes c3. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Alapin ...Nf6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6

WHITE'S IDEA

Use space and finish development while the e5 pawn gains time.

MAIN DANGER

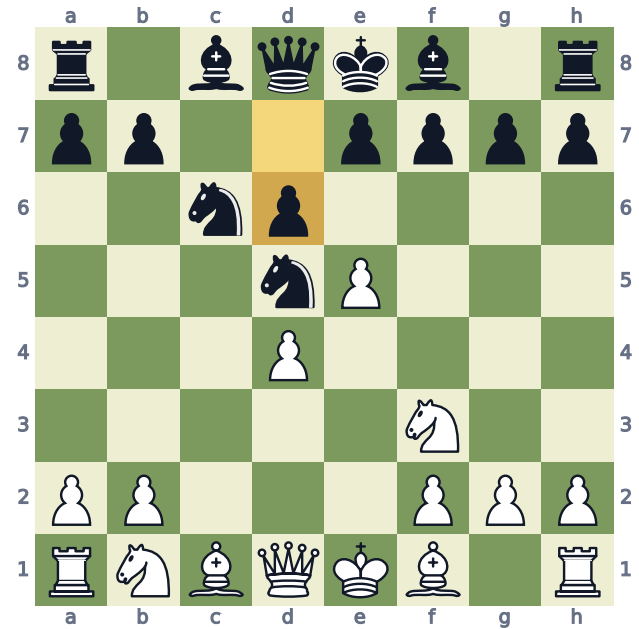
Black attacks e5 and d4 with pieces and ...d6.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Nf6 provokes e5; support the chain rather than overextend it.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

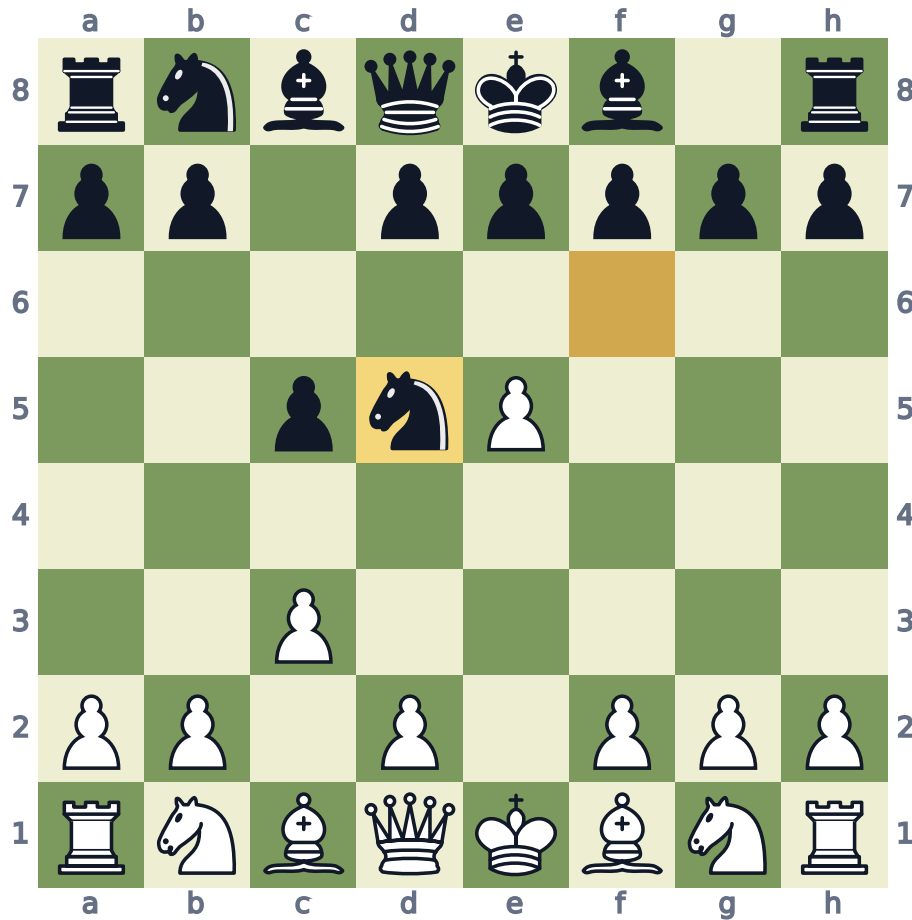
Position estimate: +0.23 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bc4 dxe5 2. dxe5 Nb6 3. Qxd8+ Nxd8 4. Bb5+ Bd7 5. Nc3 Bxb5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Alapin ...Nf6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Alapin ...d5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Be2

WHITE'S IDEA

Accept central exchanges and gain development against the queen.

MAIN DANGER

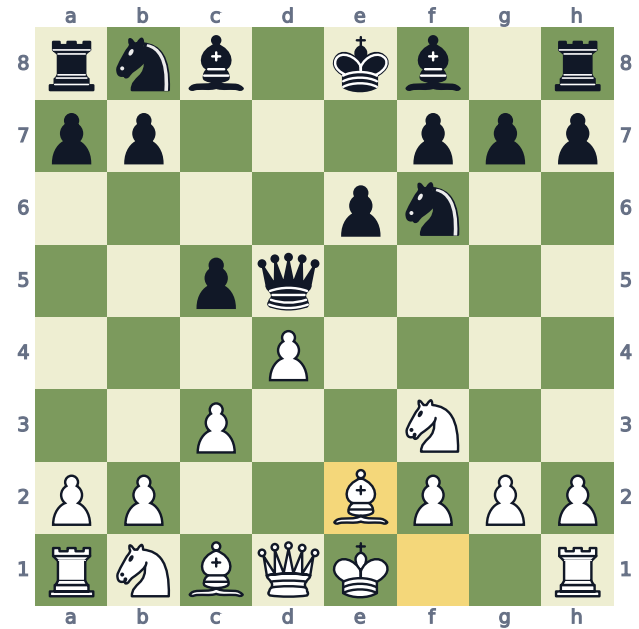
Nc3 can invite a queen capture on d4 if the center is loose.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Black achieves ...d5, develop with tempo and keep a healthy center.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.25 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. cxd4 cxd4 2. Qd8 Nc3 3. Be7 Ne5 4. Nc6 O-O 5. O-O Be3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Alapin ...d5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Alapin ...e6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 e6 3. d4 d5 4. e5 Nc6 5. Nf3

WHITE'S IDEA

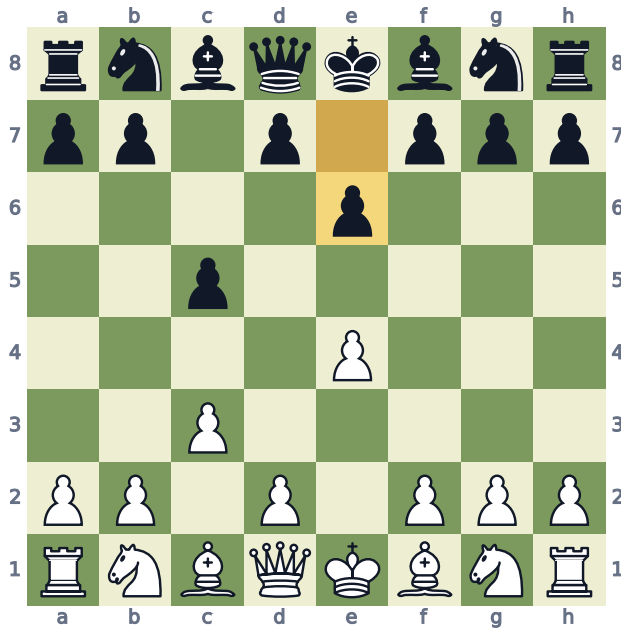
Build a French-like chain with the c-pawn already supporting d4.

MAIN DANGER

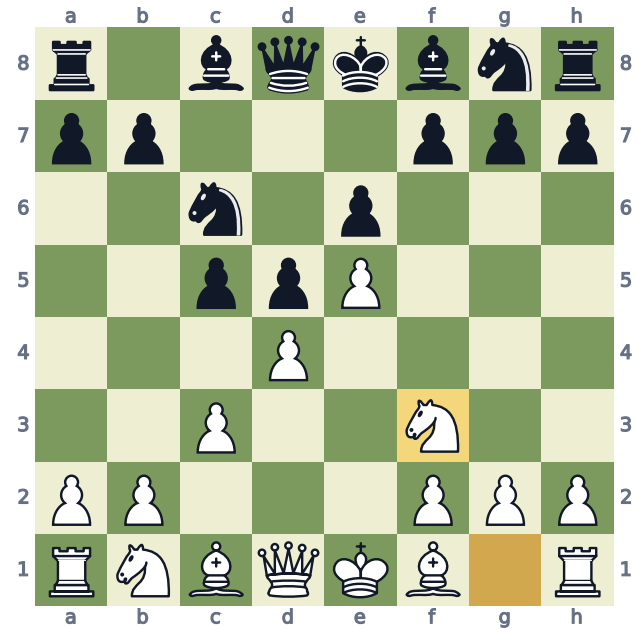
Black can attack d4 with ...Qb6 and ...cxd4.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...e6 and ...d5 transpose to a favorable familiar pawn chain.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

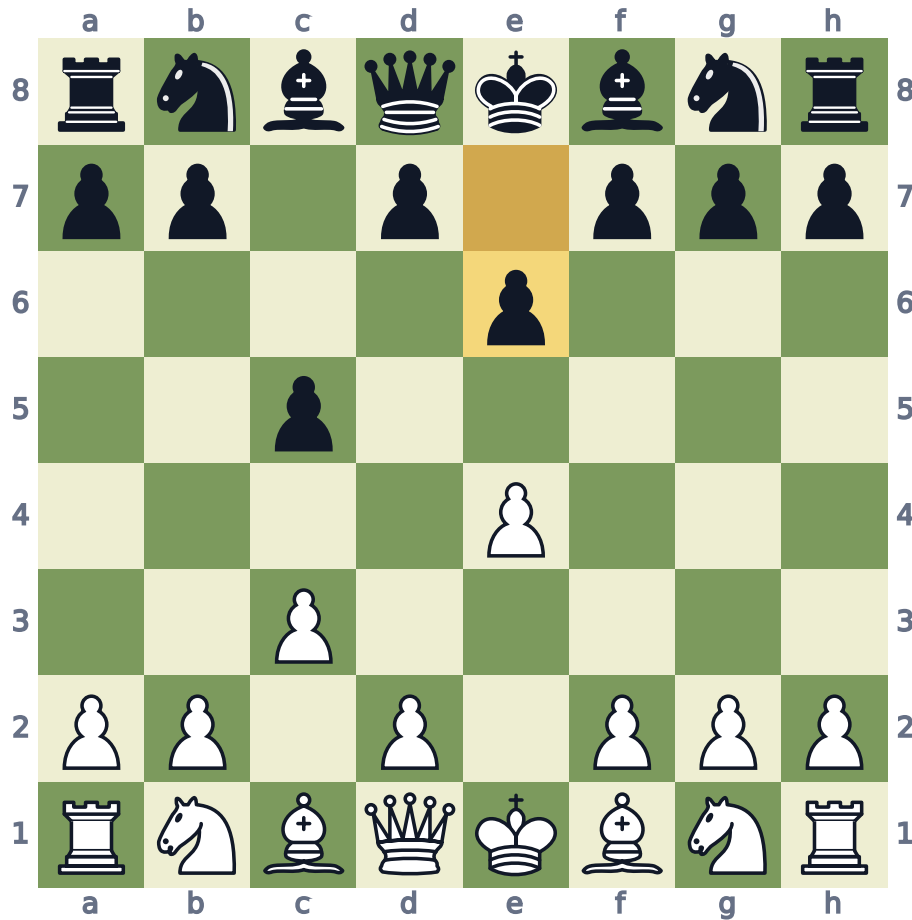
Position estimate: +0.36 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nge7 h4 2. cxd4 cxd4 3. Qb6 Nc3 4. Nf5 Bb5 5. Bd7

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Alapin ...e6



YOUR TASK

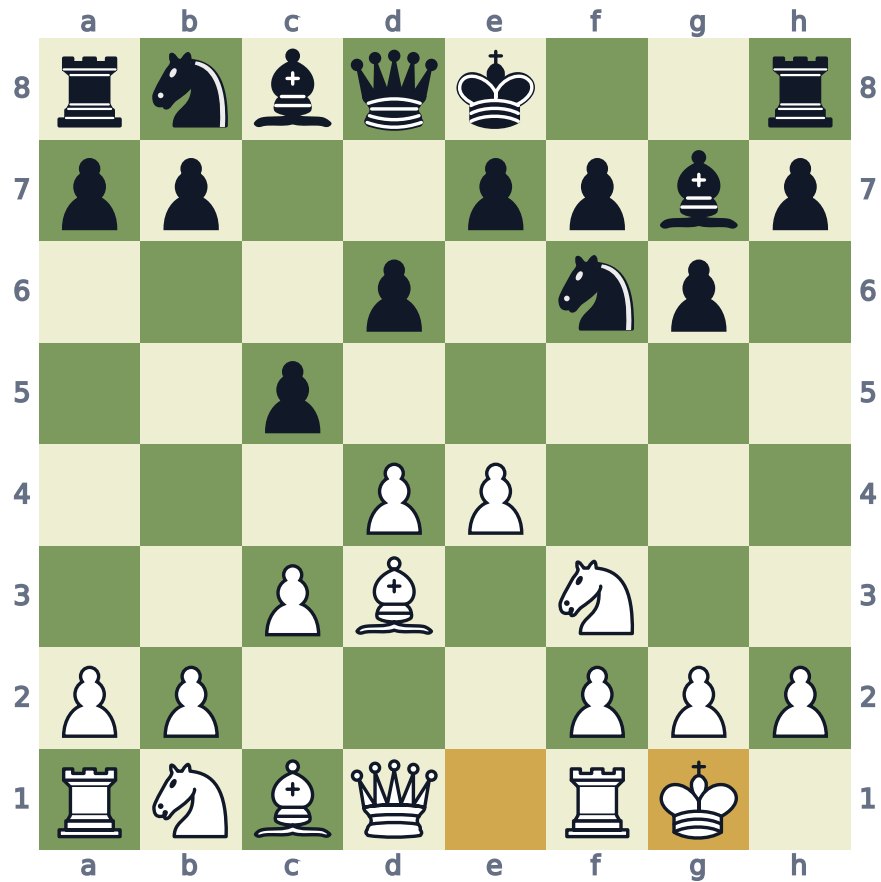
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Alapin ...d6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Bd3 g6 5. Nf3 Bg7 6. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

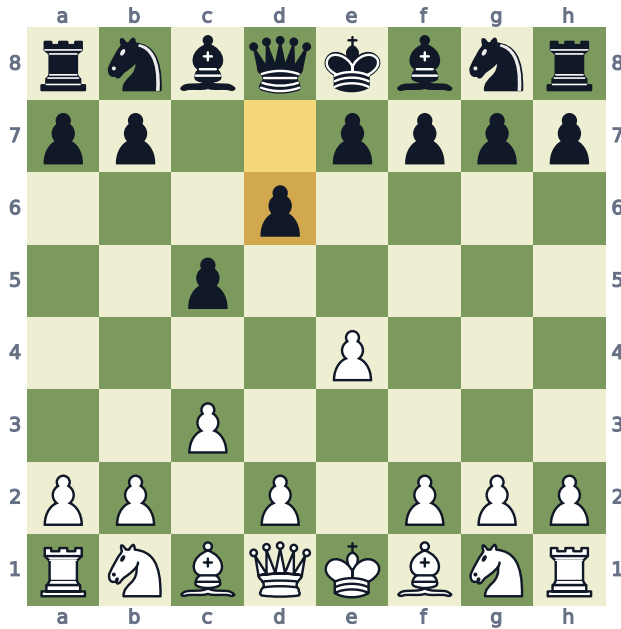
Build the center and castle before choosing e5 or Re1.

MAIN DANGER

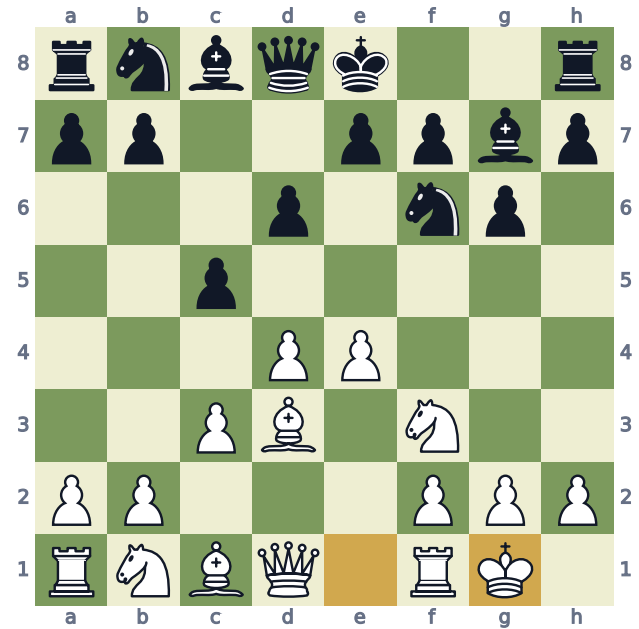
The e4 pawn can be hit by ...Bg7 and ...O-O.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

If Black delays ...d5, occupy d4 and complete development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.56 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. cxd4 cxd4 2. Bg4 Nbd2 3. O-O h3 4. Bd7 Re1 5. Nc6 a3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Alapin ...d6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Alapin ...g6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 g6 3. d4 Bg7 4. Nf3 cxd4 5. cxd4 d5

WHITE'S IDEA

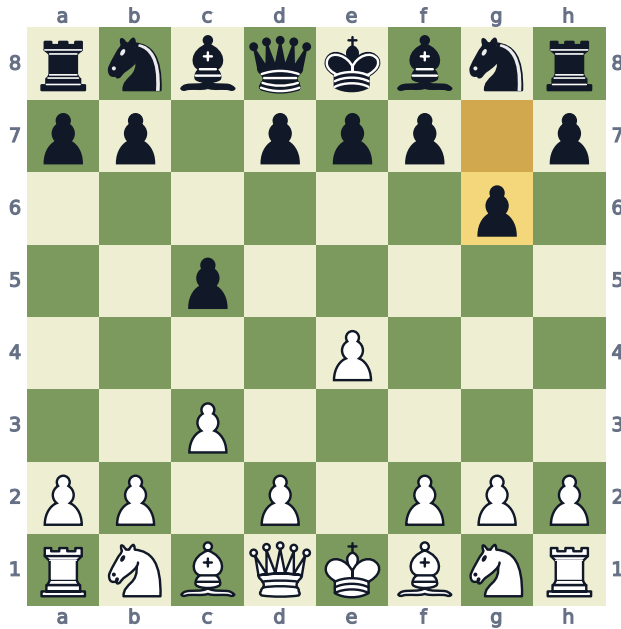
Use the center but respond accurately when Black challenges it.

MAIN DANGER

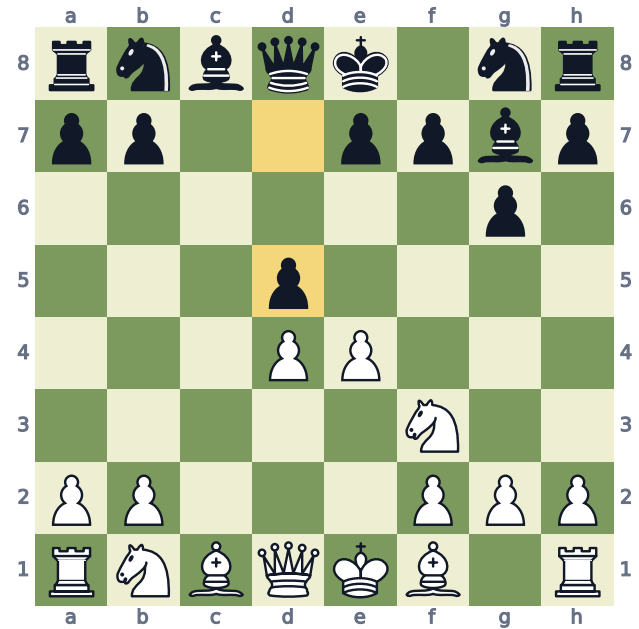
The g7 bishop targets d4 immediately after exchanges.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against a fianchetto, defend the center with pieces before expanding.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.63 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 Nh6 2. Bb5+ Nc6 3. h3 f6 4. O-O O-O 5. Nc3 fxe5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Alapin ...g6



YOUR TASK

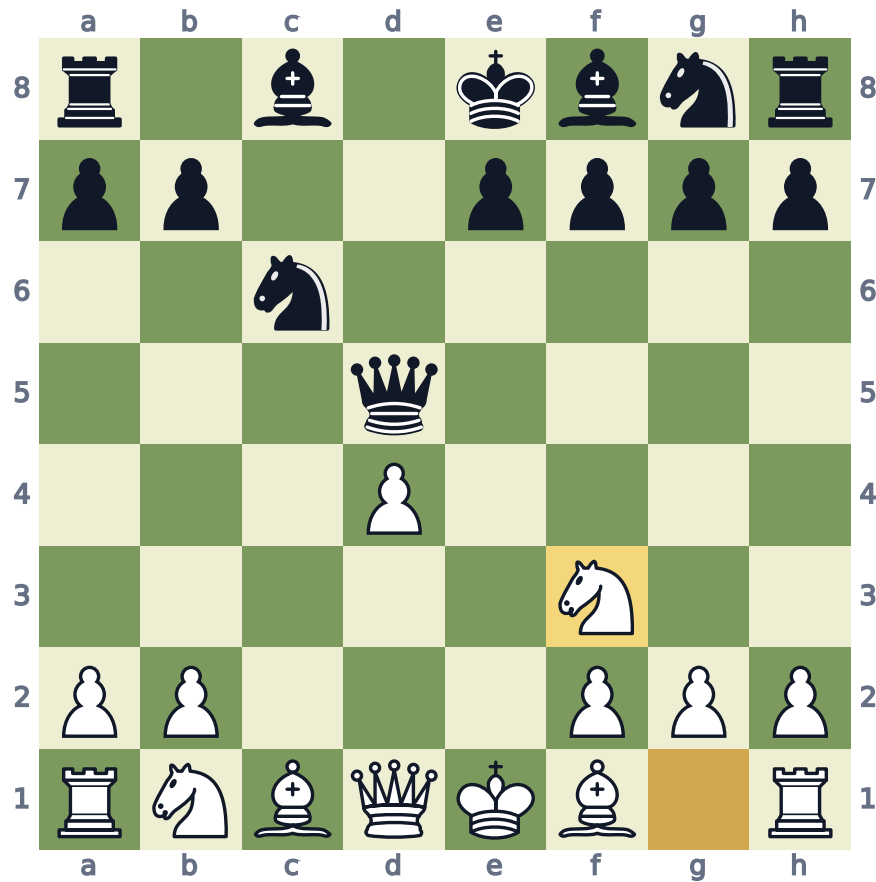
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Alapin ...Nc6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. cxd4 d5 5. exd5 Qxd5 6. Nf3

WHITE'S IDEA

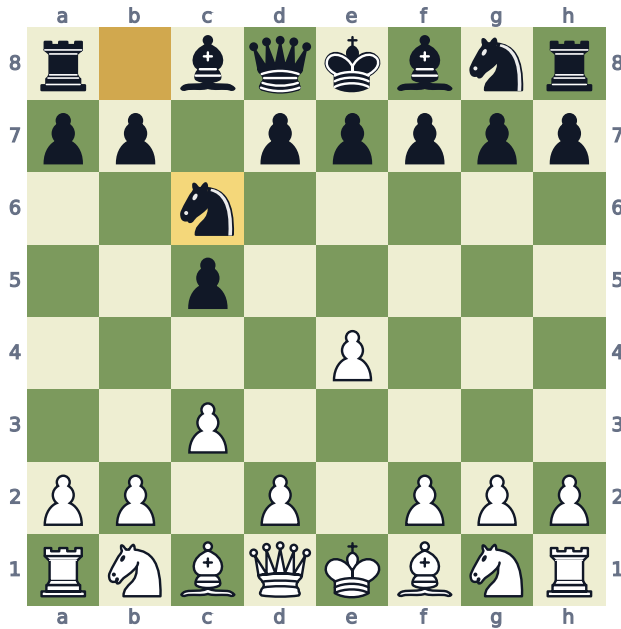
Reach an isolated or symmetrical center with active development.

MAIN DANGER

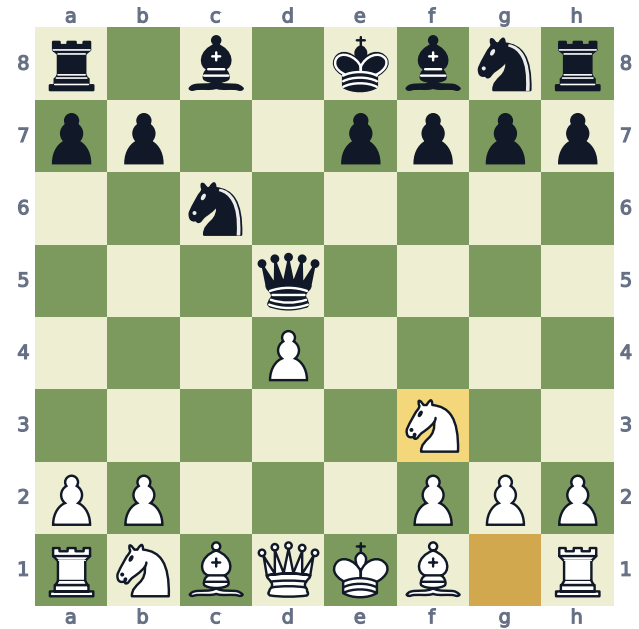
The queen may pressure d4 and g2 after exchanges.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Nc6 adds pressure to d4; clarify the center on favorable terms.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.43 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg4 Be2 2. e6 O-O 3. Nf6 Nc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Alapin ...Nc6



YOUR TASK

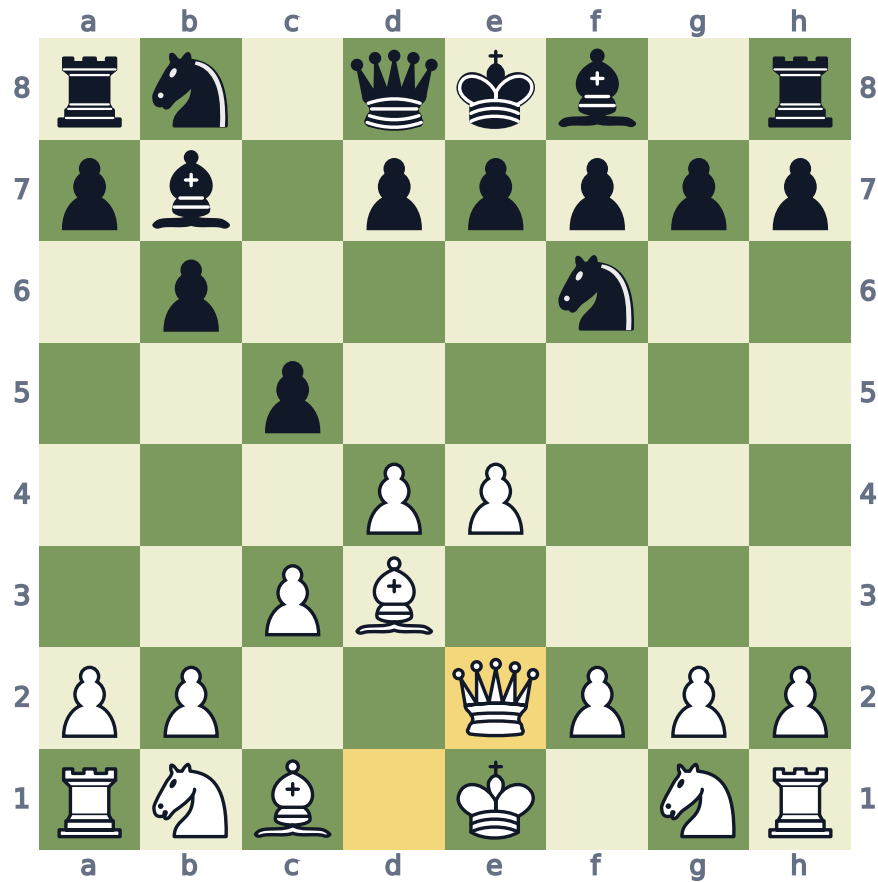
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Alapin ...b6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 b6 3. d4 Bb7 4. Bd3 Nf6 5. Qe2

WHITE'S IDEA

Protect e4 and build the center against the queenside fianchetto.

MAIN DANGER

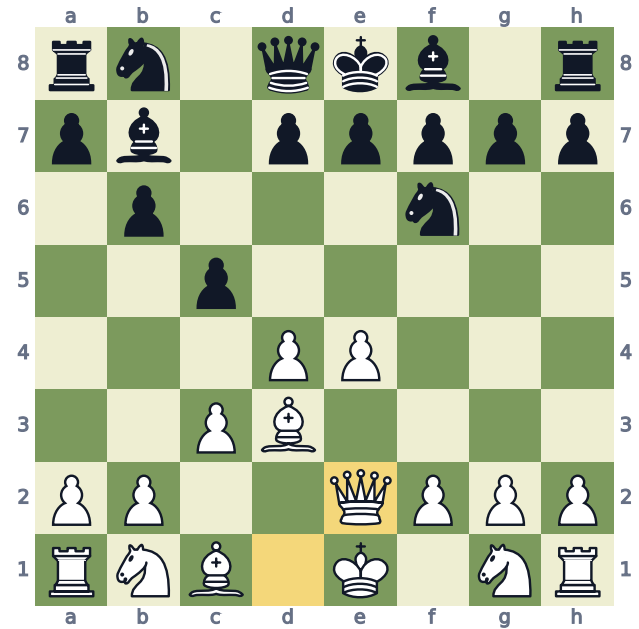
The b7 bishop can make e4 tactically vulnerable.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When ...Bb7 targets e4, add a defender before routine castling.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.52 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. cxd4 cxd4 2. Nc6 Nf3 3. Nb4 Bc4 4. Bxe4 Bxf7+ 5. Kxf7 Ng5+

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Alapin ...b6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Delayed Alapin



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. c3 d5 4. e5 Nc6 5. d4

WHITE'S IDEA

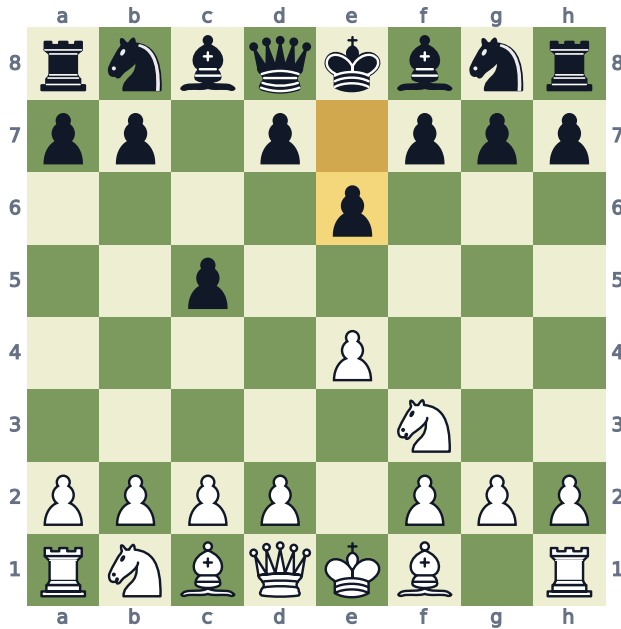
Transpose when Black's move order makes c3 useful.

MAIN DANGER

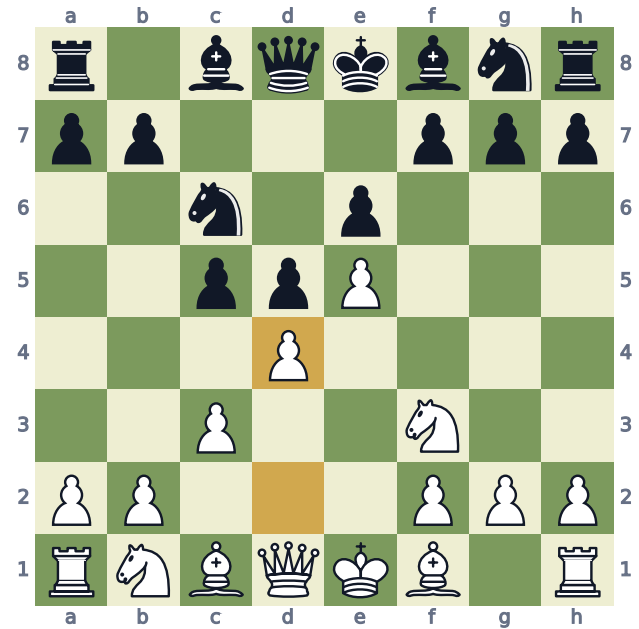
The knight on f3 can block the f-pawn but supports e5 and d4.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Recognize the structure even when Nf3 precedes c3.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

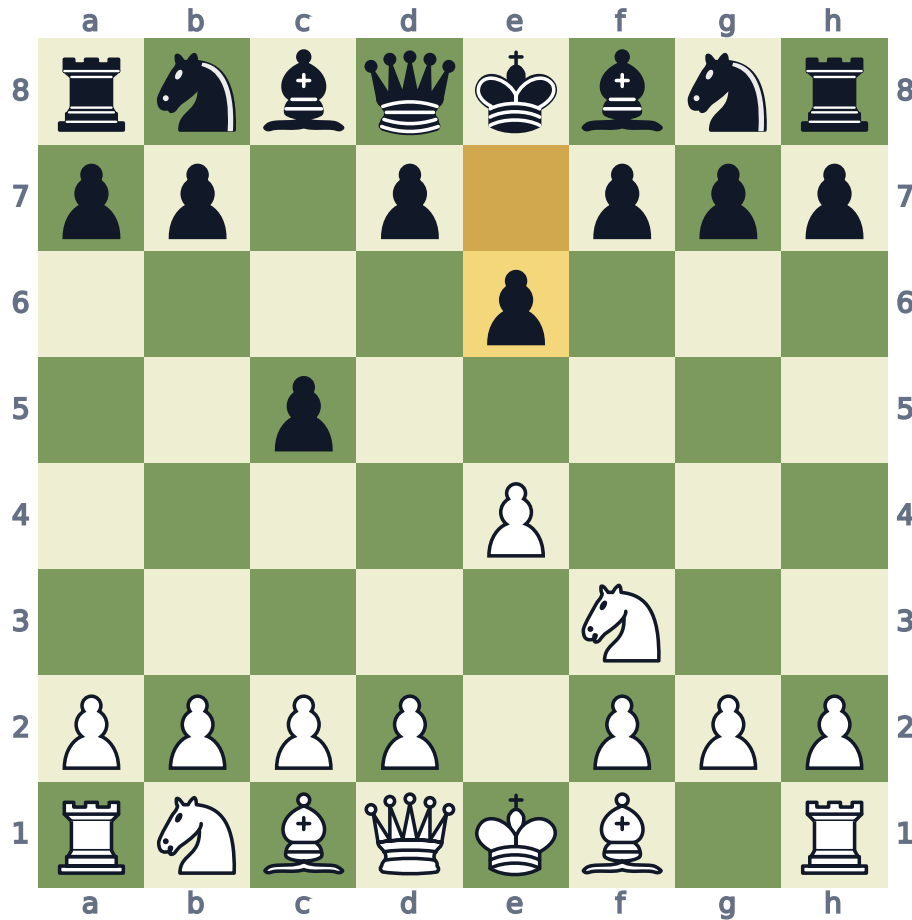
Position estimate: +0.33 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bd7 a3 2. f6 Bd3 3. fxe5 Nxe5 4. Nxe5 dxe5 5. Qc7 Bf4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Delayed Alapin



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. ALAPIN ...NF6

Course move: d4. Purpose: Use space and finish development while the e5 pawn gains time. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 d6 2. d4 cxd4 3. Qxd4 (+0.20 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black attacks e5 and d4 with pieces and ...d6.

02. ALAPIN ...D5

Course move: exd5. Purpose: Accept central exchanges and gain development against the queen. Engine comparison: 1. exd5 Qxd5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Be2 cxd4 5. cxd4 Qa5+ (+0.25 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Nc3 can invite a queen capture on d4 if the center is loose.

03. ALAPIN ...E6

Course move: d4. Purpose: Build a French-like chain with the c-pawn already supporting d4. Engine comparison: 1. d4 d5 2. exd5 exd5 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Bb5+ Bd7 5. Bxd7+ Nbx d7 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black can attack d4 with ...Qb6 and ...cxd4.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. ALAPIN ...D6

Course move: d4. Purpose: Build the center and castle before choosing e5 or Re1. Engine comparison: 1. d4 Nf6 2. Bd3 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. h3 Qc7 5. O-O a6 (+0.72 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The e4 pawn can be hit by ...Bg7 and ...O-O.

05. ALAPIN ...G6

Course move: d4. Purpose: Use the center but respond accurately when Black challenges it. Engine comparison: 1. d4 d5 2. e5 Nc6 3. Bb5 Bg7 4. Nf3 Qb6 5. Bxc6+ Qxc6 (+0.63 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The g7 bishop targets d4 immediately after exchanges.

06. ALAPIN ...NC6

Course move: d4. Purpose: Reach an isolated or symmetrical center with active development. Engine comparison: 1. d4 d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Nf3 cxd4 4. cxd4 Bg4 5. Be2 e6 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen may pressure d4 and g2 after exchanges.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. ALAPIN ...B6

Course move: d4. Purpose: Protect e4 and build the center against the queenside fianchetto. Engine comparison: 1. d4 e6 2. d5 Nf6 3. Bd3 exd5 4. e5 (+1.00 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: The b7 bishop can make e4 tactically vulnerable.

08. DELAYED ALAPIN

Course move: c3. Purpose: Transpose when Black's move order makes c3 useful. Engine comparison: 1. d4 cxd4 2. Nxd4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 Qc7 5. exf6 Bxc3+ (+0.50 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The knight on f3 can block the f-pawn but supports e5 and d4.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.